

Microsoft Ships In-House Transcription, Voice Cloning, and Image Generation Models

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Microsoft released three in-house AI models through its [Foundry](#) platform: [MAI-Transcribe-1](#) for speech-to-text, [MAI-Voice-1](#) for voice synthesis, and [MAI-Image-2](#) for image generation. MAI-Transcribe-1 averages 3.9% word error rate on the [FLEURS](#) benchmark across 25 languages, beating Whisper-large-v3 (7.6%) and Gemini 3.1 Flash (4.9%), while running batch transcription 2.5x faster than Microsoft's previous Azure Fast offering. MAI-Voice-1 generates

60 seconds of speech in one second and can clone a voice from just a few seconds of audio. MAI-Image-2 ranks [#5 on the Arena.ai text-to-image leaderboard](#) and delivers 2x faster generation, with phased rollouts underway in Bing and PowerPoint.

The pricing is what developers will notice most. Transcription starts at \$0.36 per hour, voice synthesis at \$22 per million characters, and image generation at \$5 per million input tokens. For anyone building voice agents, podcast tools, or creative apps, the combination of speed and cost matters more than marginal leaderboard differences. MAI-Voice-1's custom voice cloning from a few seconds of sample audio makes previously expensive voice production accessible to solo developers and small teams.

This is Microsoft building a full first-party model stack across speech, voice, and vision, separate from its OpenAI partnership. With these models already powering Copilot and rolling into Bing and PowerPoint, the strategy is clear: own the entire pipeline from model training to product deployment rather than reselling third-party models. For how Google is approaching the same image generation space, see [Nano Banana 2: Google's 4K Image Generation in Gemini](#).

Sources:

- [Microsoft AI Official Announcement](#)
- [MAI-Image-2 Introduction](#)
- [Arena.ai Text-to-Image Leaderboard](#)
- [MAI-Transcribe-1 Model Card \(PDF\)](#)

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